time socially effective. I confess that these doubts have not left me, and I see no satisfactory solution of the problem. I dislike violence intensely, and yet I am full of violence myself and, consciously or unconsciously, I am often attempting to coerce others. And can anything be greater coercion than the psychic coercion of Gandhiji which reduces many of his intimate followers and colleagues to a state of mental pulp?

But the real question was: can national and social groups imbibe sufficiently this individual creed of non-violence, for it involved a tremendous rise of mankind in the mass to a high level of love and goodness? It is true that the only really desirable ultimate ideal is to raise humanity to this level and to abolish hatred and ugliness and selfishness. Whether that is possible or not, even ultimately, may be a debatable question; but without that to hope for life would almost become "a tale told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, signifying nothing." To attain this ideal, are we to work for it directly by preaching these virtues, regardless of the obstructions which make it impossible of achievement and which encourage every contrary tendency? Or must we not remove these obstructions first and create a more suitable and more favourable environment for the growth of love, beauty, goodness? Or can we combine the two processes?

And then again is the line between violence and non-violence, compulsion and conversion, so obvious? Often enough moral force is a far more terrible coercive factor than physical violence. And is non-violence synonymous with truth? What is truth is an ancient question to which a thousand answers have been given, and yet the question remains. But whatever it may be, it cannot certainly be wholly identified with non-violence. Violence itself, though bad, cannot be considered intrinsically immoral. There are shades and grades of it and often it may be preferable to something that is worse. Gandhiji himself has said that it is better than cowardice, fear, and slavery, and a host of other evils might be added to this list. It is true that usually violence is associated with ill-will, but in theory at least this need not always be so. It is conceivable that violence may be based on goodwill (that of a surgeon, for example) and anything that has this for a basis can never be fundamentally immoral. After all, the final tests of ethics and morality are goodwill and ill-will. Thus, although violence is very often unjustifiable morally and may be considered dangerous from that view-point, it need not always be so.

All life is full of conflict and violence, and it seems to be true